

CHAPTER 4: Award of Master Degree in Business Administration/Executive Master in Business Administration/Social Sciences

1. Award of Master Degree in Management/Social Sciences

	Programme	Credit Hours	Duration	
			Min (On Campus)	Max
a.	Master of Business Administration (MBA) For 16 years education graduates	66	2 Years	4 ½ Years
b.	Executive Master of Business Administration (EMBA)	66	2 Years	5 Years
c.	MS Economics and HRM For 16 years education graduates with Economics and Business Administration background	36	1 ½ Years	4 Years
d.	MS Clinical Psychology For 16 years education graduates with a Psychology background	38	1 ½ Years	4 Years
e.	MS Mass Communication For 16 years education graduates with Mass Communication/Journalism/Media Studies/Public Relations background	30	1 ½ Years	4 Years
f.	MS Career Counselling and Education For 16 years education graduates with Master or Bachelors (Four Years) degree from any academic background	30	2 Years	4 Years
g.	MS Logistics & Supply Chain Management and MS Development Studies For 16 years education graduates in Engineering/BBA /MBA/B.Com from HEC/ PEC affiliated institution	36	1 ½ Years	4 Years
h.	MS Governance & Public Policy For 16 years education graduates with Master or Bachelor degree in relevant discipline	36	2 Years	4 Years
i.	MS Innovation and Entrepreneurship For 16 years education graduates (Engineering, IT, Management and Social Sciences)	36	1 ½ Years	4 Years
j.	M Architectural Design For 16 years education graduates with B. Arch degree from HEC recognized institute and accredited by PCATP.	43	1 ½ Years	4 Years

2. **Award of Degree.** On recommendations of the FBS of the School, the University will award Master degree to the students who satisfy the following conditions:

a. **MBA**

- (1) Students admitted on the basis of 16-year non-business education will complete 66 credit hours (60 credits of coursework and 6 credits of thesis research/business project).
- (2) Have achieved a minimum CGPA of 3.0 in coursework with a minimum of a **B** grade in thesis/business project (6 credit hours).
- (3) Have successfully completed 6-8 weeks internship (for MBA only).

b. **EMBA.** Have achieved a minimum CGPA of 3.00 and completed 66 credit hours. Grades assigned for the business project(s) will be counted towards the calculation of CGPA.

c. **MS**

- (1) Students admitted based on 16-year education in Economics and HRM will complete 36 credit hours (30 credits of coursework and 6 credits of thesis research) for the award of MS Economics and HRM.
- (2) Students admitted based on 16-year education in Psychology will complete 38 credit hours (30 credits of coursework, 2 credits of internship, and 6 credits of thesis research) for the award of MS Psychology.
- (3) Students admitted based on 16-year education in Mass Communication will complete 30 credit hours (24 credits of coursework and 6 credits of thesis research) for the award of MS Mass Communication.
- (4) Students admitted based on 16-year education, Master or Bachelor degree from any academic background will complete 33 credit hours (27 credits of coursework and 6 credits of thesis research) for the award of MS Career Counselling and Education.
- (5) Students admitted based on 16-year education, Master or Bachelor degree in any discipline will complete 30 credits of coursework and 6 credits of thesis research for the award of MS Development Studies.
- (6) Students admitted based on 16-year education, Master or Bachelor degree in relevant discipline will complete 30 credits of coursework and 6 credits of thesis research for the award of MS Governance & Public Policy.
- (7) Students admitted based on 16-year education with B.Arch degree will complete 33 credits of coursework and 7 credits of thesis research for the award of MS Architectural Design.

3. Scheme of Studies

- 1 The assessment scheme shall be as follows:

Nature of Examination	Duration	Frequency	Weighting (%)
End semester examination	3 hours	1	30 – 50
Mid Term	2 hours	1	15 – 25
Quizzes	-	Minimum: 3	05 – 15
Class Participation	-	-	0 – 5*
Assignments / Project(s) / Case Studies	Own time	-	10 – 40

**Shall be allocated only if there are no case studies.*

- b. The assessment scheme for EMBA shall be as follows:

- (1) In-class experiential activity (30-35%)
- (2) Project/Assignment/ Quiz (30-35%)
- (3) Midterm (optional) (10-15%)
- (4) Final (20-30%)

- c. The performance of each student in a course of study will be graded as:

Grades	
Numerical Grade	Grade Points
A	4.0
B+	3.50
B	3.0
C+	2.50
C	2.00
F	0.00
I	Incomplete
W	Dropped
Q	Qualified
T	Transfer
XF	0.00 (F Grade due to shortage of attendance)

- d. University follows a relative grading system.
- e. To earn course credits, a student must obtain a minimum of **C** grade for postgraduate programmes in each course.

4. **Offering and Registration of Courses.** The School will finalize additional courses to be offered in a particular semester well before its start but not later than last week of the previous semester keeping in view the resources available.

5. **Course Registration Procedure for EMBA Only.** Course registration will be open till the first week of the semester. A late fee to the tune of 20% of the course fee will be charged for registration from students who register in the second week. No request for registration will be entertained beyond the second week.

6. **Probation**

a. **Definition.** A student is said to be on probation if s/he is deficient in academic standards and is allowed to continue studies.

b. **Policy.** A student will be placed on probation under any of the following conditions:

- (1) If a student's CGPA is less than 3.00 but greater than or equal to 2.50 and the student does not qualify for withdrawal.
- (2) On disciplinary grounds when recommended by the respective discipline committee of the school.

7. **Suspension on Medical/Disciplinary Grounds/Acceptable Reasons.** A student may be recommended for suspension by the FBS on medical/disciplinary grounds/acceptable reasons. This suspension can be allowed if the occurrence takes place during the semester. During the period of suspension, the student will be required to pay 25% of the tuition fee.

8. **Withdrawal**

a. **Definition.** "Withdrawal" means that a student is considered unsuitable for further studies at NUST and is withdrawn from the programme.

b. **Policy.** A student is recommended for withdrawal by the FBS as per the latest policies of the University for approval by Main Office NUST subject to any of the conditions listed below:

- (1) Receives **F/XF** grade in more than two courses
- (2) If CGPA remains below 2.5 in any semester
- (3) CGPA remains below 3.00 after completion of own coursework even after availing the chance allowed under the provision for repetition of courses for improvement of CGPA
- (4) On disciplinary grounds when recommended by respective Discipline Committee of constituent institution and Discipline Committee of NUST

9. Award of F, I, and W Grades

- a. **Award of Grade F.** In addition to the **F** grade awarded based on the academic failure, a student is not allowed to appear in the final examination of a subject in which the student's attendance is less than 75%, and will be awarded **XF** grade in the said subject. The **F/XF** grade so obtained will only be cleared by repetition of the course whenever offered, so that the students are made to attend the missed course.
- b. **Award of Grade I.** A student, who, because of illness or other acceptable reasons approved by the DBS/FBS, fails to complete the required work in any course or misses any examination/test defined herein, provided the student's overall attendance is not less than 75%, is given **I** grade. The student receiving such a grade makes up the unfinished portion of the student's course and is given a grade at the discretion of the faculty without prejudice to the previous grade **I**. If a student fails to make up the coursework, s/he will be awarded an 'F' grade. However, in highly extraordinary cases, a further extension may be approved by Registrar Dte (MS Section), Main Office, on the recommendation of the FBS.
- c. **Award of Grade W.** If a student drops a course under the provision of adding/dropping of course as para 11 of this chapter, will be awarded a **W** grade.

10. **Repetition of Course(s).** A student may repeat a course under two circumstances i.e., to clear an **F/XF** Grade or to improve CGPA. The student will be required to complete all formalities applicable to the repetition of a course i.e., mid-semester examination, project, assignments, quiz, End Semester Examination, etc. The student's transcript will show both the old grade and the new earned grade, but the better grade will be used in the computation of CGPA. A student who repeats a course is not eligible for top student honours/awards even if the student improves it and comes in that bracket after repeating. The two circumstances under which a student may repeat a course are:

- a. **Clearance of W/F/XF Grades**
 - (1) A student may repeat a course to clear an **F/XF/W** grade. This repetition is not included in the provision that allowed for the improvement of CGPA.
 - (2) It will be the student's responsibility to clear the failed/dropped courses subject to the availability of resources and approval of the Dean.
 - (3) The student transcript will show both the old grade and the new earned grade, but the better grade will be used in the computation of CGPA.
 - (4) The student who repeats a course to clear a **W** grade will not be eligible for academic honours/awards.

- b. **Improvement of CGPA.** A student may repeat a course at any stage in the MS programme to improve CGPA subject to the following conditions:
- (1) For MBA/EMBA, students will be allowed to repeat a course(s) to improve their CGPA during studies as allowed to other postgraduate students.
 - (2) A student shall be allowed to repeat a maximum of three courses for MS, four for MBA, and five for EMBA during their entire coursework apart from clearance of **F** grade, if any.
- c. **Taking Alternative Elective Course.** A student may take an alternative elective course for repetition with the approval of the Dean. The student transcript will show both the old grade and the new earned grade, but the better grade will be used in the computation of CGPA. Alternative elective course taken will be counted as repeated course.

11. Adding/Dropping of Course(s) and Award of W Grade

- a. Adding/Dropping of course(s) is allowed within the first two weeks of the start of a semester. However, the student will ensure that minimum and maximum credit hours limit is followed as given below:

		Minimum	Maximum
(1)	MBA	12	21
(2)	EMBA	06	12 (Fall & Spring Semester)
		03	06 (Summer Semester)
(3)	MS	09	18

- b. A student taking less than a full semester load will not be considered for any merit scholarship/academic award.
- c. A student is allowed to drop a registered course latest by 8th week of a regular semester and 5th week of a summer semester with the recommendation of the Dean.
- d. Letter grade **W** will appear in the student's transcript against the specific course and will not be used for the computation of GPA.
- e. Students with grade **W** on the transcript will not be considered for any academic honour/award.
- f. Students of EMBA will be allowed to drop a course any time before the start of the End Semester Examination week with an award of letter grade **W**.
- g. The number of **Ws** allowed in a semester, and the maximum number that a PG student can accumulate at a time are given as under:

Programme / Credit Hours	Ws in a Semester	Maximum Ws at a Time
MBA		
66 Credit Hours	2	3
MS Economics /MS HRM		
36 Credit Hours	1	2
MS Mass Communication /MS Development Studies		
30 Credit Hours	1	2
MS Clinical Psychology		
38 Credit Hours	1	2
MS Career Counselling and Education		
30 Credit Hours	1	2
MS Logistics and Supply Chain Management / MS Governance and Public Policy / MS Innovation and Entrepreneurship		
36 Credit Hours	1	2
EMBA		
66 Credit Hours	2	4

Note: If a **W** is earned in an elective, the student may clear the **W** by registering for and passing any other elective not necessarily the same course in which a **W** grade was earned. In the case of core courses, **W** can only be replaced by repeating/passing the same course.

12. **Deferment of Semester(s).** A student may seek deferment from regular studies subject to the following conditions:

- Deferment will generally be requested before the start of a semester. However, in exceptional cases, it may be requested latest by the 2nd week of a semester. It will be endorsed by the FBS and processed for formal approval by the Director Postgraduate Programmes.
- During the period of deferment, the student will be allowed to repeat courses already studied on payment of the prescribed fee for the repetition of courses but not permitted to study new courses.
- Students will pay a 25% tuition fee to maintain their own registration.
- The student has the requisite time available to complete their degree within the stipulated time.
- Any student who opts to defer the first semester shall pay a 50% tuition fee (non-adjustable / non-refundable).

13. **Transfer of Credits.** The following shall be applicable in the case of MS/MBA/EMBA:

- Postgraduate credits may be considered for transfer from other local accredited institutions or foreign reputed institutions of a similar quality if they are relevant and appropriate to a Master programme.

- b. Only postgraduate-level courses with at least a **B** grade or equivalent will be considered for transfer.
- c. Only postgraduate-level courses completed within the last three years will be considered for transfer.
- d. A maximum of 9 postgraduate level course credits (12 credits for MS/MBA/EMBA) may be transferred but the grades will not be transferred.

14. **Research during Master Programme.** The procedure for thesis research is as under:

- a. All students must successfully complete a minimum of 6 credits in Masters' thesis/business project(s) for MBA/EMBA, based on an individualized, investigative study that will make a significant contribution to knowledge.
- b. The subject of research/business project should be agreed upon by the student and the supervisor/advisor, in consultation with GEC, when required. The research work must be original and not plagiarized, and relevant to the needs of the country.
- c. A student who cannot complete thesis work in the assigned time may continue to do so at their own arrangement/expense to complete the thesis work within the maximum allowed time.
- d. For the MS programme, a student can start research work after completion of 09 credit hours of course work provided CGPA is 3.0 or above. The thesis defence will only be allowed once a student has attained a CGPA 3.0 in coursework.
- e. An MBA student can start research work after completion of 2 semesters (36 credit hours) even if the student's CGPA is less than 3.00. However, thesis/business project defence/presentation will only be allowed once a student has attained the degree-awarding CGPA of 3.00 in coursework.
- f. Grade of thesis/business project (s) will be added in the CGPA of the student after defence/presentation in MS/MBA and will be counted towards the calculation of CGPA in EMBA.

15. **Suspension of Registration**

- a. If a student remains absent for 30 or more consecutive days without intimation or any valid reason, the student's admission/registration will be suspended. However, such students may resume the same programme subject to meeting the following conditions:
 - (1) Have completed a minimum of one semester with the minimum required GPA.
 - (2) Has been recommended by the respective institution.

- b. On re-admission, the student will pay the prescribed admission fee and 50% tuition fee for the period of absence. The rate of the fee will be as applicable to students of the semester which s/he joins.
- c. While considering the case for re-admission, it will be ascertained by the respective institution that the student has sufficient time to complete the degree within the prescribed time limit, that will start from the date of original/first admission.
- d. No special classes/courses will be planned/ arranged for such cases, other than planned classes for repeat courses.
- e. After re-admission, students' studies will be governed by the rules and regulations applicable to the entry s/he joins.
- f. Suspension of registration, on grounds of prolonged absence, will be granted only once in the programme in which s/he was originally granted admission.